

GOOGLE PLAY CONSOLE PUBLISHING GUIDE

A Step-by-Step Walkthrough for Non-Technical Users to Launch the LawOnCall App

Document Reference	LAW-PLAYSTORE- CONSOLE-LAUNCH-v1.0	Author	Antigravity AI
Target Platform	Google Play Store (Production)	Required File	app-release.aab (App Bundle)

Overview

This guide explains how to take the compiled Android App Bundle file (app-release.aab) and publish it to the Google Play Store using the online Play Console. The steps are written in plain, non-technical language to ensure any user or client can complete the registration and setup easily.



Registration Cost Breakdown:

- **Google Developer Account Registration Fee:** \$25 (USD)
- **Frequency:** One-time fee (no annual renewals or recurring monthly charges).
- **Payment Method:** Internationally enabled credit card or debit card.

Step 1: Set Up Your Google Developer Account

1. Go to the official [Google Play Console](https://play.google.com/console/signup).
2. Log in using your corporate or permanent Google Account (e.g., `contact.lawoncall@gmail.com`).
3. Select your account type: ****Developer Account for an Organization**** (recommended for professional corporate branding).
4. Fill out your developer profile (Developer Name, Organization Name, Contact Phone, and Email).

5. Complete the verification steps by uploading a scanned copy of your organization registration or your identity ID.
6. Pay the **\$25 (one-time fee)** on the checkout screen. Your account will be approved within 24 to 48 hours.

Step 2: Create a New App Listing

1. Log into your newly approved Play Console dashboard.
2. Click the blue **Create app** button in the top right corner.
3. Enter the basic parameters:
 - **App Name:** LawOnCall (or your preferred public title).
 - **Default Language:** English (United States) or English (India).
 - **App Type:** App (not Game).
 - **Free or Paid:** Free (your app is free to download; payment for legal consults happens inside the app).
4. Agree to the **Developer Program Policies** and **US Export Laws** checkboxes.
5. Click **Create app** at the bottom of the page. You will be redirected to the App Dashboard.

Step 3: Complete App Setup Declarations

Before Google allows you to upload the app package, you must answer a series of questionnaires about the app's content, safety, and payment policies.

3.1. Set Privacy Policy URL

- Go to **App Content** under the **Policy and programs** section on the left sidebar.
- Click on **Privacy Policy** and paste the link to your website's privacy policy (e.g., <https://lawoncall.in/privacy-policy>).

3.2. Set Up Payment & Financial Declarations (Razorpay / PhonePe)

✅ **Policy Exemption Detail:** Because LawOnCall charges users for actual real-world professional legal consultations (delivered by human lawyers over phone calls), it is classified as a **Real-World Service**. This exempts the app from Google Play's 15-30% billing fees. You are allowed to use your custom payment gateways (Razorpay/PhonePe) directly!

- When prompted by the financial questionnaire:
 - Select that the app **does not** sell virtual digital goods or digital coins.
 - Declare that the payments are collected for **physical or real-world professional services**.

3.3. Complete Other App Declarations

- **App Access:** Select "All functionality is available without special access restrictions" (or provide test credentials if you restrict registration).
- **Ads:** Select "No, my app does not contain ads".
- **Content Rating:** Click "Start Questionnaire". Select "Utility/Productivity" or "Communication" category, answer the standard questions (no violence, no offensive material), and click "Save" to generate a rating.
- **Target Audience:** Select "18 and over" (since it is a legal consulting platform).
- **News/COVID-19 App:** Select "No" for both options.
- **Data Safety:** Answer the questionnaire details:
 - The app collects Name, Email, and Phone Number (for registration and profiles).
 - Declare that data is "encrypted in transit" (HTTPS) and users can "request their data to be deleted".

Step 4: Prepare and Upload Store Listing Assets

Navigate to **Grow users** -> **Store presence** -> **Main store listing** on the left menu. Here you will define how your app looks on the public Google Play Store page.

4.1. Text Descriptions

- **Short Description (max 80 characters):** Instant legal consultations with verified advocates on-demand.
- **Full Description:** A comprehensive description of LawOnCall (your service features, 24/7 advocate availability, phone consultations, transparent pricing, secure legal documents, etc.).

4.2. Graphics & Screenshots

- **App Icon:** Upload your `512x512 px` PNG icon.
- **Feature Graphic:** Upload your `1024x500 px` PNG graphic.
- **Phone Screenshots:** Upload at least 2 to 4 screenshots of your app (the lawyer listings, bookings, dashboard).
- **7-inch & 10-inch Tablet Screenshots:** Upload screenshots scaled for tablets (Play Console requires this to list the app on tablet stores).

Step 5: Upload the .aab File and Launch

1. Navigate to **Release** -> **Production** on the left sidebar menu.
2. Click the blue **Create new release** button near the top right.
3. In the **App bundles** upload area, click **Upload**.
4. Select your **app-release.aab** file from your computer and wait for the progress bar to finish.
5. Google will automatically parse the file and fill out the Version Code.
6. In the **Release notes** text area, type a short message for your users (e.g., Initial release of the LawOnCall TWA Android application.).
7. Click **Save** at the bottom right.
8. Click **Review release** at the bottom.
9. Click **Start rollout to Production**!

 **Processing and Approval Time:** Once submitted, the app status will show as *****In review*****. For new developer accounts, Google's policy review team manually inspects the app bundle and domain verification (assetlinks.json). This approval process typically takes between ****2 to 7 business days****. Do not make native changes while the app is in review.